

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Chipsets

If you ever hear a conversation involving Buses, Northbridges and Southbridges, and think that the speakers are having another boring chat about travel routes, look again. Do these "travellers" wear thick glasses and appear malnourished? If so, you seem to have stumbled upon a collection of geeks, and they're really having another boring chat about Motherboards and Chipsets. And to prevent your brain from shorting out, we present... a handy-dandy geek-decoder!

Chipset n.: The real definition is just "a collection of chips designed to act as one," though it's been corrupted to refer to the chipsets on a PC's Motherboard. Note that true Geeks are fully aware of this.

Usage: "Well, I've got an nForce for my Motherboard, a GeForce for my Graphics, and an Audigy for sound. Which one did you want to know about?"

Front Side Bus n.: Like a real bus, it's a way for data to travel around the motherboard—a connection between two components.

Northbridge n.: An Intel Chipset that talks to the CPU and Memory at really high speeds via 'lanes' (different paths for different data) on the FSB.

Recommended Geek Joke: "Let's take a Bus down Memory Lane."

Southbridge n.: You guessed it... another Intel Chipset—this one talks to the other, lesser devices on the motherboard—the USB ports, power management chips and so on. To speak to the, it needs to go through the Northbridge first.

HyperTransport n.: A super-fast means of transporting data on motherboards, used by AMD Processors. It can let the processor talk to the memory and other devices without any chipsets in between.

Usage: "So do you think HyperTransport will kill the Northbridge?" (Note: Use with caution near Intel fanatics)

Great Big Image

Here at *Digit* we're always looking for stupidly geeky things to do—and we never have to look long! This month was no different:

It all started when Raaabo, on his daily *darshan* of NASA.gov, stumbled across a Torrent file. "NASA and P2P?", he exclaimed. "This will be good."

A little more reading and he soon found that the 2.9 GB Torrent was in fact a zipped 5.41 GB image of the Earth.

The word soon spread across cubicles, and all of the *Digit* bay was soon abuzz with chatter about how one would go about opening this image!

Even Solomon, our normally introverted, expressionless design head, raised an eyebrow when he heard the news! He's used to working with large images, but 5.41 GB?

Nimish, or Fatbeing as we call



Illustration: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

him, came up with the idea of using a test bed PC to try and open the mammoth image. "Let's see how long an AMD X2 with 2 GB of RAM takes to open this baby—it'll be like the ultimate test."

"Download it," screamed the masses.

A few hours later, there was a congregation of folks from various departments gathered in the test centre to witness the auspicious "opening".

Nimish was given the honours, since it was his idea.

Photoshop was opened, the image unzipped, and then Nimish proclaimed, "What's a BIN file?"

Turns out the image is a RAW, headerless BIN file, and Photoshop cannot recognise such files.

Disappointed, everyone left within 20 minutes. Nimish

remained adamant, and started downloading various RAW image readers. In fact, it's been three days since we saw him—excuse us while we go and check on him. We'll keep you informed of his success... if any!

DIGIT DIARY

these games remains to be seen, and developers are not afraid to try.

But perhaps the reason why violent games are so popular is because they allow us to be someone we aren't. None of us (hopefully!) have rocket launchers lying stashed about, or go on earth-saving missions against aliens. So if the lack of enthusiasm by youngsters to go to church on Sunday morning is anything to go by, you may not hear too much about these games in the future!

SERIAL KILLERS?

Pirates Really Are Criminals

For a long time now, the software industry has been complaining about piracy and online scams, equating "warez" peddlers to murderers. The following case might help them win their fight against software pirates, and even

have courts consider the death penalty!

Brit citizen Neil Entwistle was recently apprehended for the murders of his wife and infant. The accused reportedly shot and killed both in Massachusetts, USA. He then fled home to York in the UK, where he was arrested. However, what's interesting is that before he supposedly committed the double homicide, he was trying to sell warez on eBay! Under his eBay ID, "srpublications", he is listed as a seller for item number 583770905, which was being sold for about \$6 including shipping.

He was also selling various Adobe and Macromedia suites for a fraction of their actual price.

To add to it, item number 7569904006 on eBay.com is another get-rich-quick scheme that he was selling for about \$37. His ID has since been suspended, but you can still see the sale items if you search for their item numbers—for now at least.

So is there really a link between software piracy and homicide? Are all criminals born equal? To be honest, we don't know, but we're sure someone will come up with the results of a study soon enough to prove either possibility.

INTERNET VS CHINA

We Need Help!

Yahoo! has been under fire from most of the democratic world for buckling under the weight put on them

